Tab 1

DC Graphic Design Major Design Document

To summarize what we're aiming for:

- **Program level**: Bachelor's
- **Target learner**: High school graduates
- **Career pathways**: UX/UI, marketing, data visualization, freelancing, agency work, entrepreneurship
- **Program emphasis**: Graphic design with **design thinking** as a core methodology

We'll aim for **6–8 program learning outcomes** that balance:

- Conceptual mastery (design thinking, communication theory)
- Technical proficiency (tools, typography, UI/UX)
- Applied creativity (real-world problem solving, data vis)
- Professional readiness (portfolio, freelancing, teamwork)

Draft Program Learning Outcomes (MLOs)

1. Apply the principles of design thinking to solve complex visual communication problems across diverse media and user contexts.
2. Demonstrate proficiency in industry-standard graphic design tools and technologies to create effective visual solutions.
3. Analyze and interpret client needs, user behavior, and market data to inform user-centered design decisions.
4. Design compelling user interfaces and experiences that integrate accessibility, usability, and aesthetics.
5. Create data visualizations that translate complex information into clear, engaging, and ethically responsible visual narratives.
6. Construct a professional portfolio that showcases conceptual strength, technical skill, and process fluency across a range of design projects.
7. Collaborate effectively in multidisciplinary teams, applying project management and communication strategies used in creative industries.
8. Demonstrate entrepreneurial thinking and freelancing readiness by developing design solutions that consider branding, business goals, and client engagement.

Course-to-MLO Alignment Matrix

Course	MLO 1 Design Thinking	MLO 2 Tools & Tech	MLO 3 User-Centered Design	MLO 4 UX/UI Design	MLO 5 Data Viz	MLO 6 Portfolio & Process	MLO 7 Collab & Comms	MLO 8 Entrepreneurship
DSGN 114 – Intro to Graphic Design	✅	✅		✅		✅	✅	
DSGN 105 – Digital Imaging	✅	✅		✅		✅	✅	✅
DSGN 107 – Digital Illustration	✅	✅	✅	✅	✅	✅	✅	✅
DSGN 205 – Page Layout	✅	✅	✅	✅		✅	✅	✅
DSGN 220 – Design Thinking	✅	✅	✅	✅		✅	✅	✅
DSGN 230 – Design History	✅	✅		✅		✅	✅	✅
DSGN 312 – Packaging Design	✅	✅	✅	✅		✅	✅	✅
DSGN 310 – Corporate Brand Comm.	✅	✅	✅	✅	✅	✅	✅	✅
DSGN 320 – Motion Graphics	✅	✅	✅	✅	✅	✅	✅	✅
DSGN 412 – Portfolio Design	✅	✅	✅	✅		✅	✅	✅
DSGN 498 – Senior Capstone	✅	✅	✅	✅	✅	✅	✅	✅
DSGN 410 – Business of Graphic Design	✅	✅	✅		✅	✅	✅	✅
DSGN 491 – Design Internship	✅	✅	✅	✅		✅	✅	✅

Here's a summary of what we've accomplished together in building and mapping your **Graphic Design bachelor's program** with a focus on **design thinking**:

PHASE 1: Program Learning Outcomes (MLOs)

We created 8 clear, Bloom-aligned **Program Learning Outcomes** that reflect:

- Design thinking methodology
- Visual communication and software fluency
- User-centered and UX/UI design
- Data visualization
- Portfolio and process development
- Professional collaboration
- Entrepreneurial readiness
- Ethical, creative integration of AI tools

PHASE 2: Course Learning Outcomes (CLOs) + Alignment

We developed **detailed Course Learning Outcomes (CLOs)** for 13 core courses:

1. **DSGN 114 – Intro to Graphic Design**
2. **DSGN 105 – Digital Imaging**
3. **DSGN 107 – Digital Illustration**
4. **DSGN 205 – Page Layout**
5. **DSGN 220 – Design Thinking**
6. **DSGN 230 – Design History**
7. **DSGN 312 – Packaging Design**
8. **DSGN 310 – Corporate Brand Communication**
9. **DSGN 320 – Motion Graphics**
10. **DSGN 412 – Portfolio Design**
11. **DSGN 498 – Senior Capstone**
12. **DSGN 410 – Business of Graphic Design**
13. **DSGN 491 – Design Internship**

Each course includes:

- **5–6 targeted CLOs**
- **AI-integrated learning outcomes**
- **Explicit links to data visualization where relevant**
- **Matrices mapping each CLO to relevant MLOs**

PHASE 3: Cumulative Alignment Matrix

We created a **clean Course-to-MLO alignment matrix** showing how each course supports the broader program goals.

Summary Highlights:

- **All MLOs are covered across the curriculum** — no gaps
- **MLO 1 (Design Thinking)** and **MLO 6 (Portfolio & Process)** are heavily scaffolded throughout
- **MLO 5 (Data Visualization)** is intentionally built into courses like DSGN 107, 205, 310, 320, 498, and 410
- **AI integration** is threaded across every course — reinforcing ethical, strategic use
- **Internship and capstone** offer authentic, high-impact experiential learning

DSGN 114: Intro to Graphic Design

DSGN 114: Intro to Graphic Design

Course Purpose

This course likely serves as students' **first formal exposure to graphic design as a discipline**. It should establish:

- Core design principles (contrast, alignment, hierarchy, etc.)
- Visual literacy and critique
- Introduction to composition, typography, and layout
- Initial project work using digital tools

Course Learning Outcomes (CLOs) – *DSGN 114: Intro to Graphic Design*

1. **Identify and apply fundamental design principles (e.g., balance, contrast, alignment) in visual compositions.**
   ↳ *MLOs 1, 2*
2. **Create graphic design projects that demonstrate effective visual hierarchy, typography, and composition for print and screen.**
   ↳ *MLOs 2, 4*
3. **Use industry-standard design software to produce, revise, and export design files for professional presentation.**
   ↳ *MLO 2*
4. **Analyze and critique visual design using appropriate terminology and conceptual frameworks.**
   ↳ *MLOs 1, 6*
5. **Design and deliver visual presentations that clearly communicate design intent and process to peers and clients.**
   ↳ *MLOs 6, 7*
6. **Demonstrate an iterative design process through sketches, drafts, peer critique, and self-reflection.**
   ↳ *MLOs 1, 6, 7*

Alignment Matrix – *DSGN 114 CLOs to Program Learning Outcomes (MLOs)*

Course Learning Outcome (CLO)	MLO 1 Design Thinking	MLO 2 Tools & Tech	MLO 3 User-Centered Design	MLO 4 UX/UI Design	MLO 5 Data Visualizatio n	MLO 6 Portfolio & Process	MLO 7 Collaboration & Comms	MLO 8 Entrepreneurship
1. Apply design principles	✅	✅						
2. Create design projects		✅		✅				
3. Use design software		✅				✅		
4. Analyze & critique design	✅					✅		
5. Present design intent		✅				✅	✅	
6. Iterative design process	✅					✅	✅	

DSGN 105: Digital Imaging

DSGN 105: Digital Imaging

Course Purpose

This course likely introduces students to **core digital imaging tools** and **editing techniques**, especially raster-based (e.g., Photoshop). Key themes often include:

- Image editing, correction, and manipulation
- Resolution, file formats, color modes
- Composition for screen and print
- Ethical use of imagery (authorship, sourcing)
- Foundations of visual storytelling

Course Learning Outcomes (CLOs) – *DSGN 105: Digital Imaging*

1. **Use industry-standard software to create, edit, and manipulate raster-based digital images for print and screen.**
   ↳ *MLO 2*
2. **Demonstrate an understanding of image resolution, file formats, and color systems in the production of digital graphics.**
   ↳ *MLO 2, MLO 6*
3. **Apply compositional principles and visual hierarchy in the creation of digital imagery.**
   ↳ *MLO 1, MLO 2*
4. **Edit and retouch photographs to enhance visual clarity, consistency, and communicative impact.**
   ↳ *MLO 2, MLO 4*
5. **Evaluate digital images for clarity, ethical use, and appropriateness in professional design contexts.**
   ↳ *MLO 6, MLO 7, MLO 8*
6. **Use generative AI tools to create, remix, and enhance digital images, applying ethical considerations and creative intent.**
   ↳ *MLO 2, MLO 6, MLO 8*

Alignment Matrix – DGN 105 CLOs to Program Learning Outcomes (MLOs)

Course Learning Outcome (CLO)	**MLO 1 Design Thinking**	**MLO 2 Tools & Tech**	**MLO 3 User-Centered Design**	**MLO 4 UX/UI Design**	**MLO 5 Data Visualization**	**MLO 6 Portfolio & Process**	**MLO 7 Collaboration & Comms**	**MLO 8 Entrepreneurship**
1. Software for image creation		✅						
2. Resolution, file formats, etc.		✅				✅		
3. Composition & hierarchy	✅	✅						
4. Photo retouching		✅		✅				
5. Evaluate images ethically						✅	✅	✅
6. Use AI tools ethically		✅				✅		✅

DSGN 107: Digital Illustration

DSGN 107: Digital Illustration

Course Purpose

This course likely introduces students to **vector-based illustration** (e.g., using Illustrator or similar tools), with a focus on:

- Creating original illustrations for communication
- Vector drawing and shape-building techniques
- Style development and visual storytelling
- Design for branding, icons, infographics, and editorial use
- Possibly some integration with print or motion workflows

Course Learning Outcomes (CLOs) – *DSGN 107: Digital Illustration*

1. **Create original vector-based illustrations using industry-standard software and techniques.**
   ↳ *MLO 2*
2. **Apply design principles to illustrate concepts, narratives, or messages with clarity and visual impact.**
   ↳ *MLOs 1, 4, 6*
3. **Demonstrate proficiency in shape-building, path editing, layering, and color workflows within a digital illustration environment.**
   ↳ *MLOs 2, 6*
4. **Develop a personal illustration style through iterative practice, critique, and reflection.**
   ↳ *MLOs 1, 6, 7*
5. **Design illustrations for use in branding, infographics, packaging, or other professional design contexts.**
   ↳ *MLOs 4, 5, 8*
6. ***Apply user-centered design strategies when creating infographics or visual narratives to enhance audience understanding.***
   a. ↳ *MLOs 1, 3, 5*
7. **Use AI-assisted tools to generate, refine, or remix illustrative content while applying ethical and creative judgment.**
   ↳ *MLOs 2, 6, 8*

Alignment Matrix – *DSGN 107 CLOs to Program Learning Outcomes (MLOs)*

Course Learning Outcome (CLO)	MLO 1 Design Thinking	MLO 2 Tools & Tech	MLO 3 User-Centered Design	MLO 4 UX/UI Design	MLO 5 Data Visualization	MLO 6 Portfolio & Process	MLO 7 Collaboration & Comms	MLO 8 Entrepreneurship
1. Create vector illustrations		✅						
2. Illustrate with design clarity	✅			✅		✅		
3. Master vector techniques		✅				✅		
4. Develop personal style	✅					✅	✅	
5. Design for professional use				✅	✅			✅
6. Apply user-centered design	✅		✅		✅			
7. Use AI in illustration		✅				✅		✅

DSGN 205: Page Layout

DSGN 205: Page Layout

Course Purpose

This course typically teaches students how to organize text and images on a page (print or digital) using principles of **layout, typography, and grid systems**. It's often where students develop fluency in:

- Editorial and publication design
- Multi-page document layout (e.g., brochures, magazines)
- Typography hierarchy, spacing, and alignment
- Grids, margins, and modular structures
- File prep for print and screen
- Accessibility and readability
- Communicating ideas through composition

Course Learning Outcomes – *DSGN 205: Page Layout*

1. **Design multi-page layouts using typographic hierarchy, alignment, spacing, and grid systems.**
   ↳ *MLOs 1, 2, 4, 8*
2. **Apply principles of visual organization to enhance readability, navigation, and user engagement in print and digital formats.**
   ↳ *MLOs 1, 3, 4, 5*
3. **Prepare layout files for professional output, including proper use of margins, bleeds, resolution, and file formats.**
   ↳ *MLOs 2, 6*
4. **Integrate imagery and text to communicate clear, consistent, and audience-aware messages.**
   ↳ *MLOs 1, 3, 5, 6*
5. **Critique and revise layouts based on feedback, focusing on clarity, hierarchy, and communication goals.**
   ↳ *MLOs 1, 6, 7*
6. **Use AI-assisted tools for layout generation or content styling while applying ethical and creative oversight.**
   ↳ *MLOs 2, 6, 8*

Alignment Matrix – DSGN 205 CLOs to Program Learning Outcomes (MLOs)

Course Learning Outcome (CLO)	MLO 1 Design Thinking	MLO 2 Tools & Tech	MLO 3 User-Centered Design	MLO 4 UX/UI Design	MLO 5 Data Visualization	MLO 6 Portfolio & Process	MLO 7 Collaboration & Comms	MLO 8 Entrepreneurship
1. Design multi-page layouts	✅	✅		✅				✅
2. Visual org for engagement	✅		✅	✅	✅			
3. Prep for professional output		✅				✅		
4. Integrate image + text	✅		✅		✅	✅		
5. Revise based on feedback	✅					✅	✅	
6. Use AI for layout generation		✅				✅		✅

DSGN 220: Design Thinking

DSGN 220: Design Thinking

which is likely a cornerstone course for your program, especially given the emphasis on **human-centered design, iteration, and creative problem-solving**.

Course Purpose

This course introduces students to **design thinking as a structured process** for solving real-world problems. It likely covers:

- Empathy and user research
- Problem definition and framing
- Ideation techniques (e.g., brainstorming, SCAMPER)
- Rapid prototyping and testing
- Feedback loops and iteration
- Systems thinking and stakeholder mapping
- Applications in social innovation, UX, business, etc.

Course Learning Outcomes – *DSGN 220: Design Thinking*

1. **Apply the design thinking process—including empathy, definition, ideation, prototyping, and testing—to solve complex user-centered challenges.**
   ↳ *MLOs 1, 3, 4*
2. **Conduct user research and stakeholder analysis to inform the framing of design problems.**
   ↳ *MLOs 1, 3*
3. **Generate and evaluate multiple design concepts through rapid ideation and feedback cycles.**
   ↳ *MLOs 1, 6, 7*
4. **Develop low- and high-fidelity prototypes that exMLOre possible solutions and communicate ideas effectively.**
   ↳ *MLOs 2, 4, 6*
5. **Collaborate within interdisciplinary teams to iterate and refine design concepts based on user insights.**
   ↳ *MLOs 3, 6, 7*
6. **Use AI tools to assist in ideation, prototyping, or user research while applying ethical design practices.**
   ↳ *MLOs 2, 3, 6, 8*

Alignment Matrix – *DSGN 220 CLOs to Program Learning Outcomes (MLOs)*

Course Learning Outcome (CLO)	MLO 1 Design Thinking	MLO 2 Tools & Tech	MLO 3 User-Centered Design	MLO 4 UX/UI Design	MLO 5 Data Visualization	MLO 6 Portfolio & Process	MLO 7 Collaboration & Comms	MLO 8 Entrepreneurship
1. Apply full design thinking	✅		✅	✅				
2. Conduct user research	✅		✅					
3. Generate & evaluate ideas	✅					✅	✅	
4. Develop prototypes		✅		✅		✅		
5. Collaborate to iterate			✅			✅	✅	
6. Use AI in design thinking		✅	✅			✅		✅

DSGN 230: Design History

DSGN 230: Design History

Course Purpose

This course typically introduces students to the **historical evolution of graphic design**, exMLOring major movements, designers, technologies, and cultural influences. It often includes:

- Chronological overview (e.g., Bauhaus, Swiss, Postmodernism, Digital Age)
- Key figures and works
- Relationship between design and social, political, and technological shifts
- Critical analysis of design in context
- How historical knowledge informs contemporary practice

Course Learning Outcomes – *DSGN 230: Design History*

1. **Describe major historical movements, styles, and figures in graphic design from the 19th century to the present.**
   ↳ *MLO 1 (design thinking), MLO 6 (process fluency)*
2. **Analyze how social, political, and technological contexts have shaped graphic design across time.**
   ↳ *MLO 1 (systems thinking), MLO 6*
3. **Evaluate the visual language and communicative strategies used in historical design works.**
   ↳ *MLO 1, MLO 4 (UX/UI, audience awareness)*
4. **Draw connections between historical design trends and contemporary practices or challenges.**
   ↳ *MLOs 1, 6, 8*
5. **Communicate research findings through written, visual, or oral presentations with clarity and critical insight.**
   ↳ *MLOs 6, 7*
6. **Use AI tools to explore, organize, or visualize historical design content while practicing critical evaluation of AI-generated data.**
   ↳ *MLOs 2, 6, 8*

Alignment Matrix – *DSGN 230 CLOs to Program Learning Outcomes (MLOs)*

Course Learning Outcome (CLO)	MLO 1 Design Thinking	MLO 2 Tools & Tech	MLO 3 User-Centered Design	MLO 4 UX/UI Design	MLO 5 Data Visualization	MLO 6 Portfolio & Process	MLO 7 Collab & Comms	MLO 8 Entrepreneurship
1. Describe major movements & figures	✅					✅		
2. Analyze sociocultural context	✅					✅		
3. Evaluate historical design works	✅			✅				
4. Connect history to contemporary use	✅					✅		✅
5. Communicate research clearly						✅	✅	
6. Use AI in design history research		✅				✅		✅

DSGN 312: Packaging Design

DSGN 312: Packaging Design

This course will focus on the design of consumer-based products. Students will exMLOre various production materials and printing techniques and processes used for prototyping professional packaging designs from prepress to post production. Prerequisites: DSGN 114 and 205.

Course Purpose

This course usually exMLOres:

- Structural packaging design (folds, dielines, mockups)
- Brand identity in 3D space
- Materials, sustainability, and printing considerations
- Visual storytelling and shelf impact
- Regulatory and ethical considerations in product design
- Market positioning and target audience behavior

Course Learning Outcomes – *DSGN 312: Packaging Design*

1. **Design functional and visually engaging packaging solutions that communicate brand identity and appeal to specific audiences.**
   ↳ *MLOs 1, 3, 4, 8*
2. **Develop dielines, mockups, and 3D visualizations to prototype packaging designs for print or digital presentation.**
   ↳ *MLOs 2, 6*
3. **Apply principles of structure, hierarchy, and material consideration to ensure usability, sustainability, and impact.**
   ↳ *MLOs 1, 3, 6*
4. **Critique packaging systems based on market relevance, ethical considerations, accessibility, and visual communication.**
   ↳ *MLOs 1, 3, 4, 7, 8*
5. **Produce a packaging portfolio piece that demonstrates concept development, iterative design, and technical execution.**
   ↳ *MLOs 6, 2, 4*
6. **Use AI-assisted tools to generate or visualize packaging concepts, while critically evaluating their outputs.**
   ↳ *MLOs 2, 6, 8*

Alignment Matrix – *DSGN 312 CLOs to Program Learning Outcomes (MLOs)*

Course Learning Outcome (CLO)	MLO 1 Design Thinking	MLO 2 Tools & Tech	MLO 3 User-Centered Design	MLO 4 UX/UI Design	MLO 5 Data Visualization	MLO 6 Portfolio & Process	MLO 7 Collab & Comms	MLO 8 Entrepreneurship
1. Design packaging for audience/brand	✅		✅	✅				✅
2. Develop dielines & mockups		✅				✅		
3. Apply structure & sustainability	✅		✅			✅		
4. Critique packaging systems	✅		✅	✅			✅	✅
5. Portfolio packaging project		✅		✅		✅		
6. Use AI for packaging concepts		✅				✅		✅

DSGN 310: Corporate Brand Communication

DSGN 310: Corporate Brand Communication

a course likely focused on **brand strategy, identity systems, and communication design across platforms**.

Course Purpose

This course typically covers:

- Brand identity design (logos, visual systems, tone)
- Brand strategy and positioning
- Voice and messaging alignment
- Internal and external communication touchpoints
- Consistency across media (print, digital, social, environments)
- Stakeholder communication and brand storytelling
- Real-world brand audits or campaigns

Course Learning Outcomes – *DSGN 310: Corporate Brand Communication*

1. **Develop comprehensive brand identity systems that include logos, typography, color, imagery, and tone of voice.**
   ↳ *MLOs 1, 2, 4, 6*
2. **Apply branding principles to create communication strategies tailored to target audiences and business goals.**
   ↳ *MLOs 1, 3, 4, 8*
3. **Design brand collateral across various media platforms, ensuring consistency and clarity of message.**
   ↳ *MLOs 2, 4, 6*
4. **Critically evaluate brand effectiveness through case studies, audience response, and competitor analysis.**
   ↳ *MLOs 1, 3, 7*
5. **Collaborate to develop and pitch branding concepts using verbal, visual, and written presentation formats.**
   ↳ *MLOs 6, 7, 8*
6. **Use AI tools to assist with brand research, naming, visual development, or campaign ideation while maintaining strategic and ethical oversight.**
   ↳ *MLOs 2, 6, 8*

Alignment Matrix – *DSGN 310: Corporate Brand Communication (Concise CLOs)*

Course Learning Outcome (CLO)	MLO 1 Design Thinking	MLO 2 Tools & Tech	MLO 3 User-Centered Design	MLO 4 UX/UI Design	MLO 5 Data Visualization	MLO 6 Portfolio & Process	MLO 7 Collab & Comms	MLO 8 Entrepreneurship
1. Create brand identity systems	✅	✅		✅		✅		
2. Develop audience-centered strategies	✅		✅	✅				✅
3. Design brand collateral + data viz		✅		✅	✅	✅		
4. Evaluate brand effectiveness	✅		✅		✅		✅	
5. Collaborate to pitch brand concepts					✅	✅	✅	✅
6. Use AI in brand development		✅				✅		✅

DSGN 320: Motion Graphics

DSGN 320: Motion Graphics

an exciting course where students learn to bring visual design to life through time-based media.

Course Purpose

This course likely introduces students to:

- Principles of motion design (timing, pacing, keyframes, easing)
- Typography in motion
- Storyboarding and visual narrative
- Sound and timing integration
- Animation tools (e.g., After Effects)
- Branding through motion (e.g., logo animations, explainer videos)
- Formats for web, social, and broadcast

Course Learning Outcomes – *DSGN 320: Motion Graphics*

1. **Apply principles of animation, timing, and sequencing to create engaging motion graphics.**
   ↳ *MLOs 1, 2, 4*
2. **Storyboard and design time-based visual narratives with clear communication goals.**
   ↳ *MLOs 1, 3, 6*
3. **Animate typography, imagery, and branding elements using industry-standard software.**
   ↳ *MLOs 2, 4, 6*
4. **Integrate audio, pacing, and visual effects to enhance user engagement and storytelling.**
   ↳ *MLOs 4, 6*
5. **Critique and revise motion designs based on audience needs and platform context.**
   ↳ *MLOs 3, 5, 6, 7*
6. **Use AI tools to assist with motion design tasks such as animation generation, voice syncing, or storyboarding, while applying ethical judgment.**
   ↳ *MLOs 2, 6, 8*

Alignment Matrix – DSGN 320: Motion Graphics

Course Learning Outcome (CLO)	MLO 1 Design Thinking	MLO 2 Tools & Tech	MLO 3 User-Centered Design	MLO 4 UX/UI Design	MLO 5 Data Visualization	MLO 6 Portfolio & Process	MLO 7 Collab & Comms	MLO 8 Entrepreneurship
1. Apply animation principles	✅	✅		✅				
2. Storyboard motion narratives	✅		✅			✅		
3. Animate design elements		✅		✅		✅		
4. Integrate audio + pacing				✅		✅		
5. Revise for audience/platform			✅		✅	✅	✅	
6. Use AI in motion workflows		✅				✅		✅

DSGN 412: Portfolio Design

DSGN 412: Portfolio Design

which is a capstone-adjacent course focused on **curating, refining, and presenting a professional design portfolio** for career launch.

Course Purpose

This course typically helps students:

- Select and refine their best work
- Write case studies and project summaries
- Articulate design process and problem-solving strategies
- Design a cohesive visual and verbal identity
- Develop resumes, cover letters, and online presence
- Prepare for interviews, critiques, and presentations
- Receive peer, faculty, and industry feedback

Course Learning Outcomes – *DSGN 412: Portfolio Design*

1. **Curate a portfolio that demonstrates conceptual strength, technical skill, and process fluency across diverse design projects.**
   ↳ *MLOs 1, 2, 6*
2. **Write clear and compelling case studies that explain design intent, research, and outcomes.**
   ↳ *MLOs 1, 3, 6, 7*
3. **Design and present a cohesive personal brand identity across print and digital platforms.**
   ↳ *MLOs 4, 6, 8*
4. **Use peer and mentor feedback to revise portfolio materials for clarity, alignment, and professional impact.**
   ↳ *MLOs 6, 7*
5. **Prepare for design interviews through presentations, critiques, and storytelling strategies.**
   ↳ *MLOs 6, 7, 8*
6. **Use AI tools to support portfolio development, such as refining visuals, writing drafts, or simulating interviews.**
   ↳ *MLOs 2, 6, 8*

Alignment Matrix – *DSGN 412: Portfolio Design*

Course Learning Outcome (CLO)	MLO 1 Design Thinking	MLO 2 Tools & Tech	MLO 3 User-Centered Design	MLO 4 UX/UI Design	MLO 5 Data Viz	MLO 6 Portfolio & Process	MLO 7 Collab & Comms	MLO 8 Entrepreneurship
1. Curate professional portfolio	✅	✅				✅		
2. Write case studies	✅		✅			✅	✅	
3. Personal brand across media				✅		✅		✅
4. Revise using feedback						✅	✅	
5. Prepare for interviews						✅	✅	✅
6. Use AI to support portfolio		✅				✅		✅

DSGN 498: Senior Capstone

DSGN 498: Senior Capstone

the culminating course where students apply their cumulative skills to a major self-directed or client-based project.

Since you want to ensure **Data Visualization** is explicitly addressed, we'll make sure at least one outcome includes a component where students can **visualize research, process, or outcomes** effectively and strategically.

Course Purpose

This course typically challenges students to:

- Define and propose a comprehensive design problem
- Conduct user, client, or market research
- Apply iterative design and feedback cycles
- Manage timelines, deliverables, and presentations
- Integrate multiple design competencies (UX/UI, branding, motion, etc.)
- Present final work professionally in written, visual, and verbal formats

Course Learning Outcomes – *DSGN 498: Senior Capstone*

1. **Propose and scope a self-directed design project that addresses a real-world problem or opportunity.**
   ↳ *MLOs 1, 3, 8*
2. **Conduct research and stakeholder analysis to inform design decisions and measure impact.**
   ↳ *MLOs 1, 3, 6*
3. **Apply advanced design methods to develop, prototype, and refine a comprehensive design solution.**
   ↳ *MLOs 1, 2, 4*
4. **Visualize data and insights clearly and persuasively to support design intent and outcomes.**
   ↳ *MLOs 1, 5, 6*
5. **Present the capstone project through written, visual, and verbal formats tailored to professional audiences.**
   ↳ *MLOs 6, 7, 8*
6. **Use AI tools to support project planning, research synthesis, or asset development, with ethical and strategic oversight.**
   ↳ *MLOs 2, 6, 8*

Alignment Matrix – *DSGN 498: Senior Capstone*

Course Learning Outcome (CLO)	MLO 1 Design Thinking	MLO 2 Tools & Tech	MLO 3 User-Centered Design	MLO 4 UX/UI Design	MLO 5 Data Viz	MLO 6 Portfolio & Process	MLO 7 Collab & Comms	MLO 8 Entrepreneurship
1. Propose self-directed project	✅		✅					✅
2. Conduct research & analysis	✅		✅			✅		
3. Apply advanced design methods	✅	✅		✅				
4. Visualize data & insights	✅				✅	✅		
5. Present project professionally						✅	✅	✅
6. Use AI to support the project		✅				✅		✅

DSGN 410: The Business of Graphic Design

DSGN 410: The Business of Graphic Design

a crucial course for preparing students for the **freelance, agency, and entrepreneurial side** of the industry.

Course Purpose

This course likely focuses on:

- Pricing, contracts, and intellectual property
- Project management and client relations
- Business models (freelance, agency, in-house)
- Marketing and self-promotion
- Invoicing, proposals, and legal basics
- Ethics and professional standards
- Creative entrepreneurship

Course Learning Outcomes – *DSGN 410: The Business of Graphic Design*

1. **Describe key business models and career pathways in the graphic design industry, including freelancing, agency work, and entrepreneurship.**
   ↳ *MLOs 6, 8*
2. **Develop project budgets, timelines, and proposals in response to client or market needs.**
   ↳ *MLOs 3, 6, 8*
3. **Draft contracts, invoices, and usage rights agreements in alignment with industry standards.**
   ↳ *MLOs 6, 7, 8*
4. **Apply ethical, legal, and professional practices to client relationships, self-promotion, and content creation.**
   ↳ *MLOs 1, 6, 7, 8*
5. **Communicate business strategy through branded content, data visualizations, and presentations.**
   ↳ *MLOs 5, 6, 7, 8*
6. **Use AI tools to support business operations such as estimating, content drafting, client comms, or market research.**
   ↳ *MLOs 2, 6, 8*

Alignment Matrix – *DSGN 410: The Business of Graphic Design*

Course Learning Outcome (CLO)	MLO 1 Design Thinking	MLO 2 Tools & Tech	MLO 3 User-Centered Design	MLO 4 UX/UI Design	MLO 5 Data Viz	MLO 6 Portfolio & Process	MLO 7 Collab & Comms	MLO 8 Entrepreneurship
1. Explain design business models						✅		✅
2. Create budgets & proposals			✅			✅		✅
3. Draft contracts & invoices						✅	✅	✅
4. Apply ethical, legal practices	✅					✅	✅	✅
5. Present strategy with data viz					✅	✅	✅	✅
6. Use AI for business operations		✅				✅		✅

DSGN 491: Design Internship

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which serves as a **real-world application** of the student's accumulated skills in a professional or client setting.

Course Purpose

This course is about **experiential learning** and professional development through:

- Working in a design firm, agency, in-house team, or freelance/client-based setting
- Applying design thinking and technical skills in real-world contexts
- Building professional habits, communication, and project management
- Receiving feedback from supervisors and reflecting on growth
- Preparing for post-graduation emMLOyment or entrepreneurship

Course Learning Outcomes – *DSGN 491: Design Internship*

1. **Apply design skills and tools in a professional work environment to meet client or team goals.**
   ↳ *MLOs 1, 2, 4, 6*
2. **Demonstrate professional communication, time management, and collaboration skills in a team-based or client-facing setting.**
   ↳ *MLOs 6, 7, 8*
3. **Reflect on the internship experience to assess personal strengths, challenges, and career goals.**
   ↳ *MLOs 6, 8*
4. **Document project contributions and design process as part of a professional portfolio.**
   ↳ *MLOs 6, 7*
5. **Use AI tools to support work tasks such as prototyping, research, or presentation development while maintaining professional standards.**
   ↳ *MLOs 2, 6, 8*

Alignment Matrix – *DSGN 491: Design Internship*

Course Learning Outcome (CLO)	MLO 1 Design Thinking	MLO 2 Tools & Tech	MLO 3 User-Centered Design	MLO 4 UX/UI Design	MLO 5 Data Viz	MLO 6 Portfolio & Process	MLO 7 Collab & Comms	MLO 8 Entrepreneurship
1. Apply design in workplace	✅	✅		✅		✅		
2. Demonstrate professional skills						✅	✅	✅
3. Reflect on growth & goals						✅		✅
4. Document for portfolio						✅	✅	
5. Use AI in work tasks		✅				✅		✅